

Phishing Awareness Training

Empowering your workforce to identify and defend against sophisticated social engineering threats.

The Evolution of Phishing

From generic spam to hyper-personalized AI-driven attacks.

Traditional vs. Modern

Legacy Phishing

Broad, bulk emails with obvious typos and generic greetings like "Valued Customer". These were designed to hit as many people as possible, hoping a small percentage would fall for the ruse.

AI-Driven (2024+)

Highly targeted (Spear Phishing) using Generative AI. These attacks feature perfect grammar, mimic your company's tone of voice, and often include stolen personal details to build immediate trust.

The Psychological Hook

Tactics of Deception

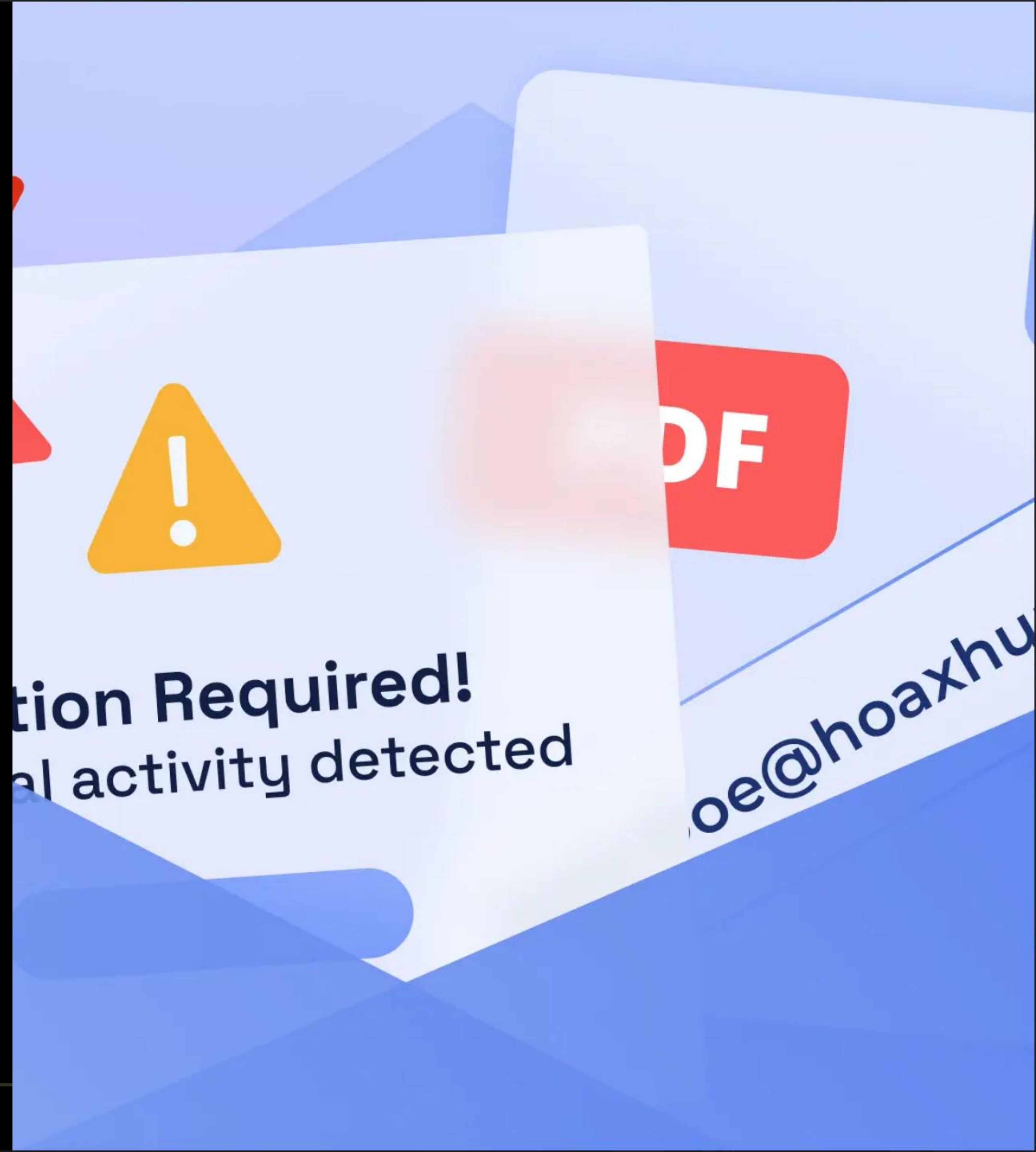
Attackers bypass technical security by hacking the human mind. They leverage four primary psychological triggers:

- 🕒 **Urgency:** "Act now or lose access forever."
- 👤 **Authority:** Spoofing the CEO or IT Director.
- ⚠️ **Fear:** "Suspicious activity detected on your account."
- 📁 **Incentive:** "Claim your bonus/reward here."



Spotting Red Flags

- @ **Spoofted Senders:** Email addresses that "look right" but are slightly off (e.g., info@mlcrosoft.com).
- 🔗 **URL Mismatches:** The link text says 'Login', but the destination is a string of random numbers.
- 📎 **Unexpected Invoices:** Unsolicited attachments designed to trigger an immediate click.



Multi-Channel Threats



Smishing

Phishing via SMS. Often appears as package delivery alerts or banking notifications with urgent links.



Vishing

Voice phishing. Attackers use AI voice cloning to impersonate trusted individuals or official help desks.



Quishing

QR code phishing. Malicious codes in public places lead to fake login pages or immediate malware downloads.

Site Comparison: Real vs. Fake

FEATURE	LEGITIMATE SITE	PHISHING PORTAL
URL Path	Matches official brand (brand.com)	Contains hyphens or subdomains (brand-verify.net)
Padlock Icon	Issued to the correct organization	Often missing or issued to a generic site
Interactive Elements	All links and buttons are functional	Only the 'Login' or 'Submit' buttons work
Tone/Branding	Consistent and professional	Slight color variations or low-res logos

The Business Cost

\$17B

BEC Losses Worldwide

Targeting the C-Suite

Business Email Compromise (BEC) is the most profitable attack vector today. By targeting finance departments with "Whaling" attacks, criminals have diverted billions of dollars into fraudulent accounts via social engineering.

Defense & Incident Response

Creating a human firewall to protect organizational data.

Security Best Practices

- 🛡️ **MFA is Mandatory:** Multi-factor authentication stops 99.9% of account takeovers.
- 🔍 **Think Before You Click:** Hover over every link. Verify the destination.
- ☎️ **Out-of-Band Verification:** If a request is unusual, call the sender on a known number.
- 🚩 **Report Immediately:** Use the Phish-Alert button to warn the entire network.



Interactive Quiz: Spot the Hook

You receive an email from "Microsoft Security" at 'service@outlook-update.co' claiming your account is compromised. What is the first thing you should do?

A. Click the "Secure Account" button immediately to prevent further access.

B. Reply directly to the email asking for more technical details about the breach.

C. **Hover over the link to verify the destination and report the sender to IT.**

D. Forward the email to your entire team to see if anyone else received the warning.

Stay Vigilant.

Thank you for attending the Phishing Awareness session. Security is everyone's responsibility.

IT Security Desk: 555-010-999

Report Portal: security-report.internal

Image Sources



<https://www.isoeh.com/images/fbi-email-hack-exposed-iran-linked-cyber-attack-signals-a-dangerous-shift-in-cyber-warfare.webp>

Source: www.isoeh.com



https://cdn.prod.website-files.com/6130a9118b1be9aebe2c2837/667aa023fc5dd1b62adfd6ae_Phishing%20Red%20Flags.webp

Source: hoaxhunt.com



https://media.easy-peasy.ai/27feb2bb-aeb4-4a83-9fb6-8f3f2a15885e/0385edb4-f72c-4b62-99d0-09504d2805bd_medium.webp

Source: easy-peasy.ai
